

Chapter 27 Part 1

The sound of running water drowned out their conversation.

The group of people from the office quickly left after washing their hands, ending their brief gossip session.

But Liang Shi never came out.

She frowned as she quickly browsed through all the information online related to Chen Liuying and Bai Weiwei.

The official information released was scarce, and netizens' revelations were all filled with "maybe" and "probably," with very few accurate descriptions.

Online discussions about this incident had already exploded.

[My friend saw Bai Weiwei at the entrance of Huayue International the day before yesterday. She was walking with a group of executives, and her expression was so fawning she might as well have been shining their shoes.]

[Going to Huayue International doesn't necessarily mean she was drinking with clients, right? Huayue International is a legitimate place.]

[If it wasn't for drinking with clients, why would she jump off a building? She must have been xx'd.]

[Do you have evidence? Don't make things up without proof.]

[We happened to pass by Huayue International around 10 PM the day before yesterday and saw a very beautiful Alpha carrying Bai Weiwei out. At that time, Bai Weiwei looked like... well, like it was afterwards.]

[Then how do you know it wasn't that beautiful Alpha who did it with her? Why insist that she was drinking with clients to get resources?]

[Exactly! Ridiculous! Our Liuying doesn't need her to do these things, okay? Her drama bookings are already scheduled until the year after next!]

[Ugh! Who doesn't know Chen Liuying is just a marketing fraud? Don't try to muddy the waters upstairs.]

[With that green-screen acting skills of hers, what a waste of that face.]

[...]

The online flame war intensified, while Chen Liuying's studio had yet to make any response.

Two hours had passed since this incident broke out, already missing the optimal PR timing.

Bai Weiwei's suicide attempt was probably beyond their expectations, leaving the studio in chaos with no one able to respond promptly.

Meanwhile, photos had also surfaced online.

The most widely circulated and credible ones were of Bai Weiwei entering Huayue International with a group of executives, and of Zhao Xuning carrying her out of Huayue International.

Someone just happened to capture them.

The latter photo was very blurry.

But everyone online said it was a very beautiful Alpha, so people believed it.

After all, from the photo, you could see the Alpha had a great figure.

After exiting Weibo, Liang Shi called Zhao Xuning, but her phone was turned off.

"..."

Helplessly, she could only go to the hospital.

//

The hospital entrance was surrounded by crowds.

Reporters from major media outlets had already rushed over after hearing the news, holding cameras¹ and waiting in the hospital, while security personnel continuously maintained order, but couldn't make them all leave.

Everyone was working hard to get first-hand information.

Because of Bai Weiwei alone, the hospital's order was disrupted. Ten minutes later, a hospital official came out and said: "Bai Weiwei has been transferred to a private hospital. Please leave, reporters."

Initially, people didn't believe it. Many reporters held up microphones asking, "Is Bai Weiwei still alive?"

"How serious are Bai Weiwei's injuries? What are her chances of survival?"

"What is Chen Liuying's attitude about this? Is she at the hospital accompanying Bai Weiwei?"

One sharp question after another made the hospital official lose patience. When microphones were thrust directly at his mouth, he pushed them away and said coldly: "Sorry, these are all patient privacy matters. Please leave the hospital, reporters. Don't disturb the hospital's normal operations. If you haven't evacuated within five minutes, we will take forceful measures to remove you."

He left after speaking.

The crowd of reporters looked at each other in confusion.

Although they were unwilling to believe it, Bai Weiwei had indeed been transferred.

But they had no choice but to stop disrupting public order and went outside to stake out.

When Liang Shi entered, she wanted to find Bai Weiwei but discovered no one would help her.

The name "Bai Weiwei" had become taboo in the hospital.

She couldn't contact Zhao Xuning either, otherwise she could have asked Zhao Xuning to take her upstairs.

However, she found a workaround and asked the nurses' station, "Did Dr. Zhao Xuning come in today? I need to see her about something."

"Sorry, Dr. Zhao doesn't have a shift today," the nurse said. "If you need medical attention, please go to the payment counter to register. Thank you."

Liang Shi: "..."

She was rebuffed.

She then went upstairs to Zhao Xuning's office, but found it locked. A Beta nurse passing by recognized her and greeted her, "Ms. Liang, are you looking for Dr. Zhao?"

Liang Shi nodded, "Do you know where she is?"

The little nurse shook her head, "Our hospital doesn't allow us to say. You should contact her yourself. Dr. Zhao won't be coming to work today."

"Do you know about Bai Weiwei..." Before she could finish, the little nurse frantically shook her head, "I don't know, please don't ask."

She ran away after speaking.

This incident had caused quite a stir online, especially since it involved a human life.

Particularly with Chen Liuying bearing the title of "Internet's Number One Imperial Alpha²," she had exploded overnight after just entering the entertainment industry, creating resource conflicts with many people.

Now that something had happened to her, many were waiting to watch her downfall. Some competitors had already started buying internet trolls to steer public opinion. Negative keywords about Chen Liuying kept trending on hot searches, climbing higher and higher in rankings.

The hashtag #Chen Liuying Manager Jumping Off Building# remained at the top with consistently high engagement, steadily occupying first place with a deep red "exploding" character following it.

Liang Shi wanted to confirm Bai Weiwei's condition, but due to the special circumstances, she could only return empty-handed.

However, as she was going downstairs, she received a call from an unknown number.

She originally wanted to hang up, fearing it might be some unsavory person again.

But considering Bai Weiwei's situation, she answered, "Hello?"

"This is Zhao Xuning." The other party said directly, "This is my personal number."

Hearing this, Liang Shi immediately asked: "How is Bai Weiwei? What happened that night? Why did she suddenly jump off the building?"

Ten minutes wasn't enough time to do anything.

Moreover, from what she knew of Bai Weiwei, she didn't seem like someone with a fragile heart.

"She just got out of life-threatening danger," Zhao Xuning's voice sounded exhausted. "She wasn't violated that night."

"Then..." Liang Shi paused, "Why did she jump off the building?"

"She fought with her girlfriend," Zhao Xuning was also helpless. "She jumped when her emotions got too intense."

Liang Shi: "..."

Isn't her girlfriend you?

Liang Shi's words got stuck in her throat and didn't come out.

So it was a misunderstanding.

"The specific details are too complicated," Zhao Xuning said. "I can't explain it clearly in a phone call. I just called Xu Qingzhu but she didn't answer. When she asks about it later, please explain for me."

Liang Shi readily agreed, "Okay."

"It's better not to let her see the online comments," Zhao Xuning instructed. "She's not suitable for intense emotional fluctuations right now."

"Mm." Liang Shi also gave instructions in return, "By the way, Xu Qingzhu blacks out when she drinks too much and doesn't remember anything from that night, so it's better not to bring it up if possible. Let's just turn the page on this matter."

"Okay."

Everything had been said, and they could have hung up.

But for a moment, neither hung up, and instead they both sighed simultaneously.

"I'll get back to work," Zhao Xuning said. "Take good care of Xu Qingzhu."

"I know. If you have new information, tell me too. If Xu Qingzhu finds out about this, she'll definitely want to visit Bai Weiwei. When she wakes up or when visitors are allowed, please let me know. Thank you, sorry for the trouble." Liang Shi said politely.

"Okay."

After responding, Zhao Xuning suddenly said teasingly: "You sound much more pleasant now when you speak."

Liang Shi: "..."

She had always spoken pleasantly.

It was the original owner who was unpleasant!

However, she didn't chat much more with Zhao Xuning. She still had to go back to work at the company. Knowing that Bai Weiwei was safe put her mind at ease.

After hanging up, she drove back to the company.

Footnotes:

1. **长/槍短炮 (cháng qiāng duǎn pào)** - Literally "long guns and short cannons," this is a Chinese idiom referring to cameras with long and short lenses, commonly used to describe photographers and reporters with their equipment.
2. **禦A (yù A)** - "Imperial Alpha" - In Chinese ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) fiction, this refers to a dominant, powerful Alpha character. The "禦" (imperial) suggests someone with commanding presence and authority.